THE HOLY MOUNTAIN
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By Alejandro Jodorowsky

"The Holy Mountain" perfectly captures the psychedelic, sexually explicit, mystic, anti-establishment ethos of the Age of Aquarius*. Plot-wise, the movie follows a character known as "The Thief," played by Horacio Salinas, who encounters an alchemist, portrayed by Jodorowsky himself. The alchemist guides The Thief and a group of other individuals, each representing a different planet in the solar system, on a quest to find the Holy Mountain. Along the way, they face a series of surreal and allegorical challenges that serve as metaphors for the human condition. "The Holy Mountain" delves into themes such as religion, consumerism, the quest for enlightenment, and the nature of reality. The film tells a surreal, at times incomprehensible, story grounded on tarot-card imagery. One notable aspect of the film is its use of esoteric symbolism and mysticism. Jodorowsky draws inspiration from various spiritual traditions, including tarot cards, alchemy, and Eastern philosophy, to craft a narrative that challenges conventional norms and invites viewers to question their perceptions of reality. "The Holy Mountain" is a visually striking film, featuring elaborate and symbolic imagery, intricate set designs, and richly detailed costumes. The motion picture has a notable influence on contemporary fashion, particularly in terms of its avant-garde and visually stunning aesthetic. The film's elaborate costumes, surreal imagery, and

Stills from 'The Holy Mountain' film. Alamy

figurative elements have inspired designers, artists, and fashion enthusiasts, contributing to the creation of unique and unconventional looks. As a king of cult cinema, Jodorowsky is a regular source of inspiration for cult fashion brands. London-based label Fyodor Golan named its SS 2013 collection included hats by Zara Gorman, reminiscent of those in the film. In 2012 the film influenced a collection by experimental jewelry line "Ambush". Based in Tokyo, the brand was founded by hip-hop artist and graphic designer Yoon. In 2010, the film was recreated as a fashion editorial called "City of God" by Mario Sorrenti for V Magazine. "Santa Sangre", 1989 is an avant-garde horror film co-written by Claudio Argento and Jodorowsky which has inspired Spanish designer Leyre Valiente's SS 2013 capsule**, and South Korean Lie Sang Bong, whose SS 2011 collection featured trompe l'oeil motifs related to Jodorowsky's films. "The Holy Mountain" entered mainstream consciousness when it was acknowledged by Kanye West as a major influence on aspects of staging and costuming of his "Yeezus" tour in 2013. This included jeweled Maison Martin Margiela masks that replicated the fly-encrusted face of The Thief at the beginning of the movie. While not directly mainstream, the influence of "The Holy Mountain" can be observed in various avant-garde fashion circles and the work of designers who appreciate and incorporate unconventional and artistic elements into their creations. The film's lasting impact on the intersection of cinema and fashion continues to inspire those who seek to push the boundaries of conventional aesthetics.

Written by Aleksandra Eremashvili

*in astrology, is either the current or forthcoming astrological age, depending on the method of calculation. Astrologers maintain that an astrological age is a product of the Earth's slow precessional rotation and lasts for 2,160 years, on average.

**For her SS13 collection called 'Chimaera', it's very obvious designer Leyre Valiente found inspiration in the different stages of metamorphosis, realized through animal anatomy + the human skeletal structure (above) depicted in some of the pieces. The thread was sewn underneath the fabric to make it look like tendons or veins on the human body. Others had panels that looked like those found on a suit of armor or the exoskeleton of an insect, with a delicate touch. Occasionally, visible stitches were added to look like scars. Leyre also worked with leather, creating a dress silhouette that looks almost regal with it's high shoulder pleated detail and pockets.